Exploring Pro-Code Extension of a Zoho Creator Application Using Zoho Catalyst and Custom Functions

Aim

To explore the pro-code extension capabilities of Zoho Creator using custom functions and Zoho Catalyst to extend application functionality, implement advanced business logic, and integrate external services.

Introduction

Zoho Creator is a low-code development platform that enables users to create applications using forms, reports, dashboards, and workflows. However, complex business requirements may require additional programming capabilities.

Pro-code extensions allow developers to use custom functions, APIs, and external services to implement advanced features. Custom functions in Zoho Creator can be written using Deluge scripting, while Zoho Catalyst provides a platform for developing and deploying backend services.

Procedure

A. Using Custom Functions in Zoho Creator

1. Log in to Zoho Creator and open the Rainwater Harvesting Record System application.
2. Navigate to the workflow or application logic section.
3. Open the existing Deluge workflow or create a new custom function.

4. Define a business requirement, such as checking the current water level of a storage tank.
5. Write a Deluge function to compare the current water level with the tank capacity.
6. Configure the function to execute when the relevant record is submitted or updated.
7. Save the function and test it using sample tank records.
8. Verify that the function produces the expected alert or result.

B. Exploring Zoho Catalyst

1. Open the Zoho Catalyst developer platform and sign in.
2. Explore the available backend development features, such as serverless functions and API-based services.
3. Identify a suitable use case for the Rainwater Harvesting Record System, such as analyzing rainfall records or generating water usage summaries.
4. Explore how a Catalyst backend function could process the required data.
5. Study how the backend service could communicate with Zoho Creator through supported APIs.
6. Review authentication, authorization, and error-handling requirements for secure communication.
7. Test the integration in a development environment if the required Catalyst project and API access are available.

Applications

- Automating advanced business rules using custom functions.
- Generating rainfall and water usage summaries.
- Processing large amounts of data using backend services.
- Integrating external applications through APIs.
- Extending low-code applications with pro-code functionality.

Result

The pro-code extension capabilities of Zoho Creator were explored using custom functions and Zoho Catalyst. Custom functions provide a way to implement additional business logic using Deluge scripting, while Zoho Catalyst can support backend processing and external service integration.

Thus, the experiment demonstrates how low-code applications can be extended with programming capabilities to support more complex requirements and improve application functionality.